

CAREER PATHS

An actor's career can be unpredictable. Training and talent may help you land good and well-paid roles, but you also need luck and perseverance to be spotted and to be selected at auditions. Finding a respected agent to represent you may help you get noticed.

AMATEUR ACTOR Joining an amateur drama group, or appearing in student films or stage productions, can help you get noticed as a young, aspiring actor.



GRADUATE You can study for an academic degree in drama or theater studies at college or choose a course focused on acting at a drama school.



ACTOR You may need to join a professional body or an actor's union to be considered for some acting roles. You may need to learn new skills throughout your career, such as stage fighting and perfecting dialects, to win roles.



SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to perform with confidence in front of an audience or camera.



Must be able to work closely with directors, producers, camera operators, and members of a cast.



Creativity to interpret a script and the director's instructions with a fresh perspective.



Stamina and fitness to rehearse over long periods and to deal with the physical demands of acting.



The ability to analyze scripts and memorize dialogue, directional cues, and choreography.



FILM ACTOR Performs in front of cameras on movie sets, often repeating scenes several times in different "takes." Many actors start their careers in low-budget independent movies.



TV ACTOR Performs a role for a TV show, such as a soap opera or period drama. Some TV actors may also find work in corporate videos or in TV and online advertisements.



STAGE ACTOR Performs in front of audiences in a range of venues, from small, intimate studios to large open-air theaters, or even on the street.



VOICE ACTOR Works on radio dramas, or provides voice-overs for commercials, animations, training materials, or audiobooks. They are hired for the quality of their voices.



STUNT PERFORMER Stands in for other actors on set when the film or TV script calls for a scene that is physically dangerous or that requires specialized skills.